

# MOUNTAIN REVIEW

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION NEWSLETTER

*Volume IV* *Issue II* *Spring 2014*

## HIGHLIGHTS

**"Dog City" Memories**



Photos of the bizarre construction of Mtn. View's tallest building bring back lots of interesting memories.
**Page 4**

**Hop on Board!**




Find out how you can help the MVHA share Mountain View's history!
**Page 5**

**Spring Meeting Preview**



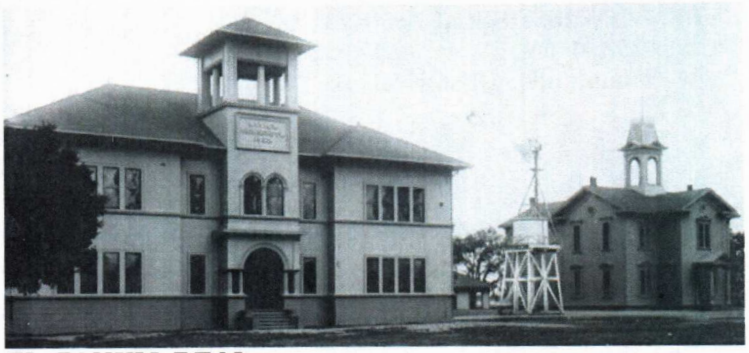

Learn about our Spring meeting program, A Tribute to Mountain View's High Schools
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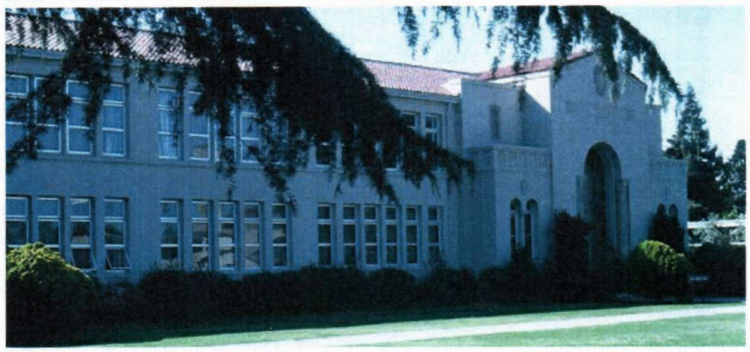
## THE CAMPUSES OF MVHS

1902-1924



**EL CAMINO REAL**

1924-1981



**CASTRO STREET**

1981-TODAY



**TRUMAN AVENUE (OPENED AS AWALT IN 1961)**

In anticipation of our Spring Event, our cover features the three campuses which have been called Mountain View High School. For more information on our Spring Event - See Page 6!

1954-2014
60
MOUNTAIN REVIEW

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**MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION**
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
**www.mountainviewhistorical.org**

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## In Memoriam

**George Holden**
*May 14, 1921 - January 13, 2014*

**Gail Urban Moore**
*March 22, 1928 - January 24, 2014*

# News & Notes



Volunteers relocate Mtn. View artifacts to be displayed at the Los Altos History Museum.

## President's Message

By Patricia Figueroa
*MVHA President*

Hi Everyone,

As I shared with you in the Winter edition of the *Mtn. ReView*, the Mountain View Historical Association Board is placing a special emphasis on increasing our visibility in the community in 2014. This is a special year for us as we are celebrating the 60th Anniversary of our organization! We are reviewing a variety of activities in which we can participate and hope many of you will join us. More information will be shared at our May meeting. Until then, a few updates on some of our upcoming activities:

**Spring Parade:** We will start off the year by participating in Mountain View's Downtown Spring Parade to be held on Saturday, April 26th. If you'd like to join our contingent, e-mail me for more information.

**Partnership with Los Altos:** Although we are not currently going forward with our museum, we are working with the Los Altos History Museum to loan, for display, some of the larger items donated to the Mountain View Historical Association. Volunteers have already moved many of these items to Los Altos.

**Bryant Park Plaza Display:** A Historical Subcommittee is also working with Roger Burnell to develop part of an interactive display window at his project at the corner of Villa and Bryant (where the Pearson House was located). One of the elements of the display is titled "Yesterday: Our Mountain View History". This is still a work in progress – we'll keep you up to date as this project proceeds.

Remember to mark your calendar for 1pm on May 4th , the date of our Spring Public Event and Membership Meeting, where we will focus on Mountain View High School history and end the program with a memorable performance by the Mountain View High School Madrigal Singers!

# New to the History Center

By Barbara Kinchen
*Historical Data Chair*

**From Mrs. Carla Holtzclaw:** Four photos of the Jurian family

**From Mr. and Mrs. George Fortune of San Jose:** Over two dozen snapshots of the Redwine family and some genealogical information about the Redwine family in Arkansas.

**From the Sunnyvale Historical Society:** Painting by Anna Knap Fitz of the 1902 Mtn. View High School on El Camino at Calderon Avenue.

**From Sandra Murdock of Idaho:** Two snapshots of the school and grounds at El Camino and Calderon in 1913-1914.

**From member Eugene Sharp:** Copy of 1970 photo showing the Rengstorff House and barn viewed from Space Park Way.

**From member Vivian Schatz:** Disk showing some of her personal photo collection. These include some of her own Stickney family, as a Johnny Mac's car-hop and as a Miss Mountain View contestant in 1949.

**From Javier Perez:** Small scrapbook containing 31 snapshots taken in 1948 by Mrs. Bess Hardy, second grade teacher at Dana Street School. A newspaper article explains that Mrs. Hardy's students were learning about people in Mountain View who are considered "Community Helpers." One picture shows Postman Frank "Happy" Holden. Another shows several students and bankers Austin Spencer and Virgil Cooper.

# Financial Report

By John Figueroa
*Treasurer*

Checking Account Balance as of 12/11/13: $ 7,641.31

- Income: $269.99
- Expenses: $979.55

Checking Account Balance as of 3/12/14: $ 6,931.85

Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 12/11/13: $82,831.19
Certificates of Deposit Balance as of 3/12/14: $83,006.11

## Mtn. View Memories

The *Mtn. ReView* needs you! Help us create an even better newsletter by submitting your memories and photos of life in Mountain View. E-mail submissions to:
***mvha.newsletter@gmail.com.***
Mail them to the *Mtn. ReView* at:
***298 Pettis Avenue, Mtn. View CA 94041***

## The History Center

The Mountain View History Center's mission is to collect, organize and make available Mountain View historical resources and to promote the city's heritage. It contains the historic archives of both the Mountain View Historical Association and the Mountain View Public Library. Historical books and pamphlets on the history of Mountain View are also available for purchase at the History Center.

**Location:**
Mountain View Public Library, 2nd Floor
585 Franklin Street
Mountain View, CA 94041

**Hours:**
The history center is open to the general public from 1-5pm every Tuesday and by appointment.

***Call 650-903-6890 for more information.***

*Do you own photos or historic documents related to MV history that you would like to add to MVHA's archives? If so, please contact us! We are also happy to accept digital copies, and can help you digitally scan materials if you are local. Your contributions to our archives help us preserve and share Mountain View's history!*

# On the Web

On March 6 the MVHA reached 444 "likes" on facebook - meaning 444 people now follow our page (As of April 5, we have 563!) To commemorate like No. 444 - we posted the following - and it generated quite a response!

***"Today we reached 444 likes! So how about a photo of Mountain View's tallest building - 444 Castro Street - aka, the IED Building, aka, Mountain Bay Plaza, aka...well, go ahead and tell us YOUR favorite name for this oddly constructed building!" - MVHA***

"Dog City!"
**-H. Morgan**

"The Dog House."
**-L. Harlow**

"World's biggest kennel."
**-J.Floyd**

"...the Dog Building!"
**-H.Spitz**

"Dog City! I was there once as a little kid when the dog handler was feeding them. He said, "come pet them, they won't hurt you". They were all bark and no bite!"
**-G.David**



"My father in law was the building inspector in Mountain View and had to climb up the stairs to inspect the construction of this building."
**-R.Vipham**

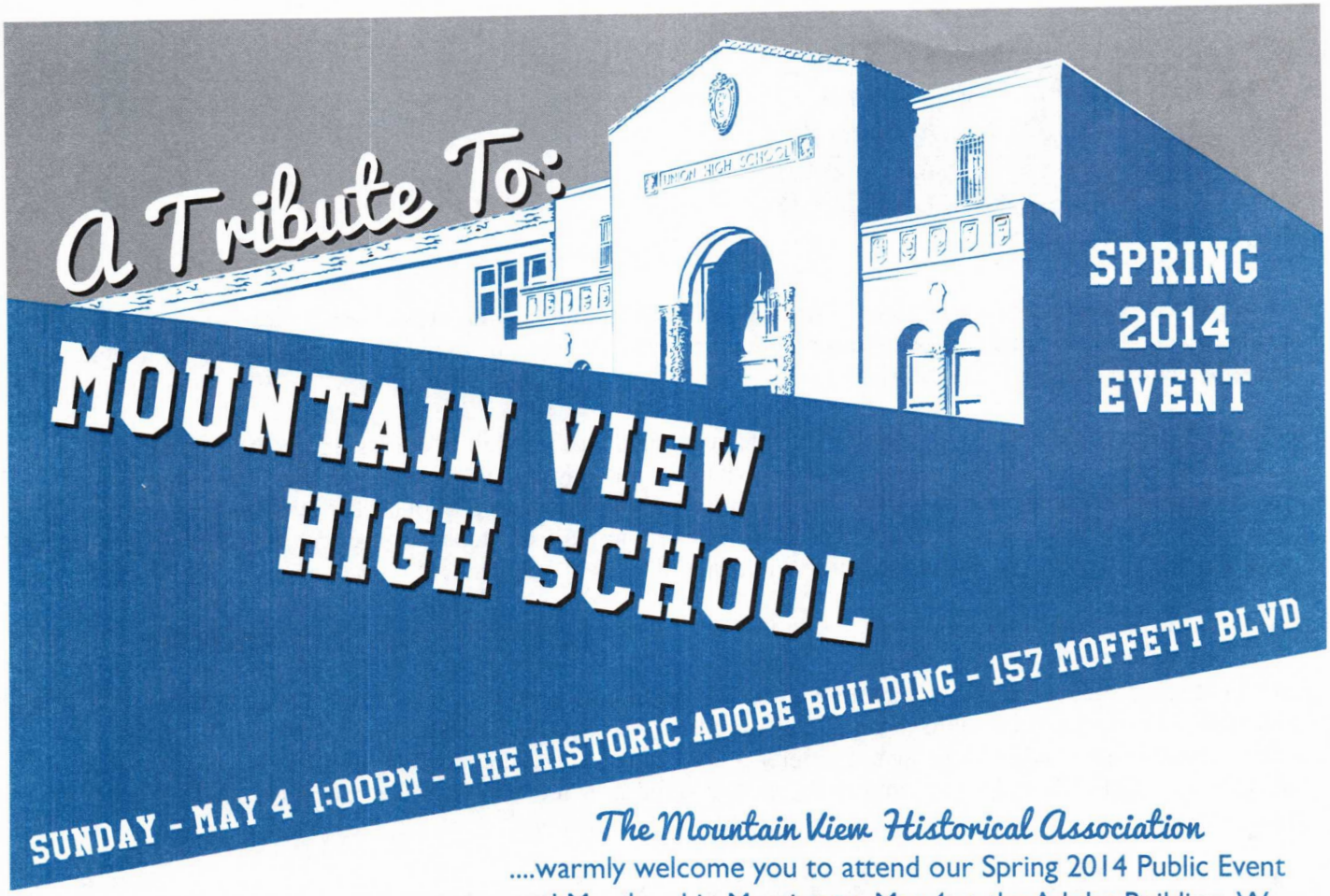
"Started to build in fall of 1969...180 Feet high structure= first high rise building since El Camino Hospital's 6 story total height plus large wide red brick chimney on top added on in 1963-1964. ... lot of doggie poops all over the bank floor before new BA open for business..
**-K.Scharninghausen**

"For us Mountain View newbies (I've lived here since 2003, but compared to some of you that makes me a newbie!), why was it called Dog City?"
**-S. Stefanek**

"...they built it then it sat empty for a long time, so they filled the building with Dobermans for security."
**-S.M.McVeigh**

"Mr. Rognier, teacher at MVHS, called it "the white elephant". I looked up the definition of that phrase and found that it is "a possession that is useless or troublesome, especially one that is expensive to maintain or difficult to dispose of." He assigned me the task of researching the building and presenting before the class. I contacted the attorneys that were involved in negotiations to make it possible to have the building occupied. Their explanation was so complicated and confusing that I invited them to class to explain it so I wouldn't have to. ;o)"
**-B. Williams**

***Join the conversation! Visit: www.facebook.com/MVHistory***




# A Tribute To:

# MOUNTAIN VIEW HIGH SCHOOL

**SPRING 2014 EVENT**

**SUNDAY - MAY 4 1:00PM - THE HISTORIC ADOBE BUILDING - 157 MOFFETT BLVD**

*The Mountain View Historical Association*

....warmly welcome you to attend our Spring 2014 Public Event and Membership Meeting on May 4 at the Adobe Building. We will be celebrating the history of Mountain View High School, with a special focus on its second campus, which opened 90 years ago on Castro Street in May of 1924. The event is free and open to the public.

*Featuring:*

**"FROM EAGLES TO SPARTANS"**

*Lecture and slideshow by local author Nick Perry*

**"THE MVHS STORY"**

*A Screening of the Award-Winning Film*







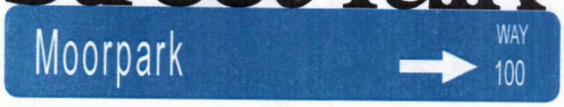
*....and a special musical performance by :*

## THE MTN. VIEW HIGH MADRIGALS

*For more information on-line visit:*

www.facebook.com/MVHistory

# Street Talk




By Barbara Kinchen
*Historical Data Chair*

Driving east on Dana Street from Calderon Avenue, you pass Landels School, cross over Highways 85 and 237, and then the street ends at Moorpark Way. Researching the origin of this name for a segment of the original Mountain View-Alviso Road has been very interesting.

By 1961, there was a mobile home park on the Alviso Road: Moorpark Mobile Homes. Today the address is 501 Moorpark Way. The new street name was adopted in 1965 and may very well have been named for the already established mobile home park. This park was built by Mr. Louis Moore on part of his orchard holdings. Perhaps he grew Moorpark apricots. However, earlier in 1946, Herbert and Wilfred Moore used three acres of their orchard to create fourteen lots on Alice Avenue which was named Moore Park Subdivision.

So we have Moore Park Subdivision, Moorpark Mobile Home Park, Moorpark Way, and Moorpark Apricots!!

Current Moore family members do not know if all these names are correct or if there have been mistakes in spellings. Louis, Herbert, and Wilfred were all sons of Henry S. and Charlotte Moore who came to Mountain View in about 1920 from Jamaica. They owned a motel, Moore Court at 1012 El Camino Real. All seven children, Evelyn, Louis, Arthur, Doris, Wilfred, Ernest and Herbert were Mountain View High School grads in the 1920s. And there are still members of the family living in the area, some on Alice Avenue.

# A Call for Volunteers

The Mountain View Historical Association is looking for local members who want to help us share Mountain View's history with the community! You don't need to be a lifelong resident or expert on MV history to apply - in fact, volunteering is a great way to learn about local history. Roles we are currently looking to fill are described below:

**Memorials & Remembrances Chair:** Serve on our Executive Committee! Help us commemorate important Mountain View milestones and honor the lives of MVHA members and community leaders.

**Event Volunteers:** Help staff MVHA's table at public events such as the Downtown Spring Parade, Art & Wine Festival, Thursday Night Live, and Santa Clara County Fair. A great activity for first-time volunteers and fun way to meet people interested in local history!

**Mtn. View History Center Volunteers:** Help maintain our archives and interact with the public at the Mountain View History Center on the second floor of the library.




*If you're interested in these or any other volunteer opportunities please e-mail us at* mvha.newsletter@gmail.com

*Or call MVHA President Pat Figueroa at* 650-965-4783